

THE CLASSIFICATION ERROR

WHEN **TERRITORY** IS LEFT OUT OF INFRASTRUCTURE

Before the crisis, there was a classification.
What we failed to classify as essential
ceased to have continuity.



WATER



SOIL



FORESTS



POLLINATORS



THERMAL
REGULATION

Infrastructure
is not always
what we build;
**it is what our
continuity
depends on.**

BIOIA / WUOM

TERRITORY • EXPERIENCE • READING
ORIENTATION • DECISION • RETURN



ROADS



POWER GRIDS



BRIDGES



SUPPLY
SYSTEMS



FINANCIAL
SYSTEMS

THE CLASSIFICATION ERROR

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THE PROBLEM DOES NOT BEGIN WITH THE CRISIS

A territorial crisis usually becomes visible when its consequences appear:

water scarcity, soil loss, wildfires, floods, declining production, economic damage, displacement, or pressure on public services.

But by then, the process has already been underway for some time.

Before the crisis, there was a classification.

We decided what had to be maintained, protected, funded, inspected, and repaired. And we also decided, even if we did not formulate it that way, what could remain outside those categories.

A road is infrastructure.

A bridge is infrastructure.

A power grid is infrastructure.

A financial system is infrastructure.

But what about the soil that sustains production?

What about a watershed that regulates and distributes water?

What about a forest that moderates temperature, humidity, and erosion?

What about the pollinators on which part of plant reproduction depends?

They do not stop being essential because we have placed them under a different label.

The hypothesis

Many crises that we call environmental can also be read as infrastructure failures.

Not because nature and infrastructure are the same thing, but because the material continuity of our societies depends on systems that we still treat as external to the system we intend to maintain.

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Orientation precedes action.

THE FIRST ERROR IS CLASSIFICATION

Institutions do not treat all dependencies in the same way.

What we classify as critical infrastructure activates concrete mechanisms:

maintenance, budgets, inspection, redundancy, emergency protocols, and long-term planning.

What remains outside that classification tends to enter a different logic:

conservation, compensation, post-damage restoration, or environmental management separated from the main infrastructure system.

This is where the asymmetry appears.

A power grid is maintained before it collapses.

A bridge is inspected before it falls.

A financial system is stress-tested before it fails.

But many living systems continue to be managed only once deterioration is already visible.

BIOIA introduces another question here:

Who classifies, and from where is the classification made?

If classification begins from the built object, territory appears as surroundings.

If it begins from dependency, territory appears as an **operational base**.

That completely changes the reading.

This is not about turning nature into a road, a bank, or a power grid.

It is about recognizing that **a society also depends on infrastructures it did not build.**

The shift in criteria

**From “what we have built”
to “what continuity depends on.”**

THE CLASSIFICATION ERROR

The problem appears when we confuse **administrative category** with **material importance**.

We classify as infrastructure whatever interruption we immediately recognize as a risk to continuity: transport, energy, communications, finance, supply.

That activates maintenance, budgets, inspection, redundancy, and emergency protocols. Yet many living systems sustain equally essential functions and generate equally deep dependencies, while often remaining outside those same structures of protection and continuity.

BIOIA introduces another question here:

Who classifies, and from where is the classification made?

Because a category can be technically well defined and still be territorially misplaced.

If soil loses fertility, if a watershed loses regulatory capacity, if a forest loses continuity, or if pollination declines, the system may continue functioning for some time.

That delays the perception of failure.

Built infrastructure usually signals when it breaks.

Living systems can degrade while continuing to provide service.

This is where the error appears:

confusing apparent continuity with the absence of deterioration.

That is why BIOIA does not simply propose expanding the list of infrastructures.

It proposes incorporating three references into the classification process:

Territory → where it happens and what materially sustains.

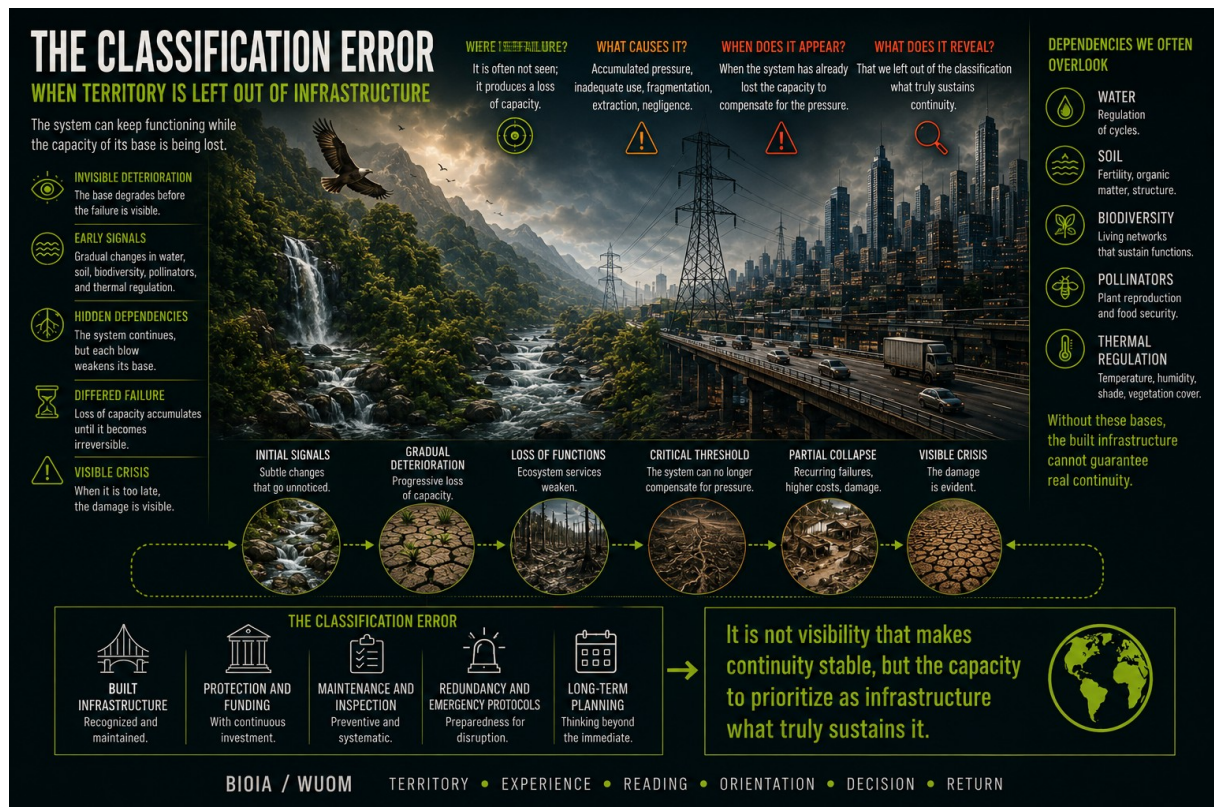
Experience → which signals, changes, and memories are present.

Reading → which patterns, dependencies, and relationships can be recognized.

Only then can priority be discussed.

Classifying is not naming.

Classifying is deciding what deserves continuity.



BIOIA Diagnosis • Invisible Deterioration.

Apparent continuity can persist while the territorial base that makes it possible is degrading. Water, soil, biodiversity, pollination, and thermal regulation lose capacity before failure becomes visible. **The signal precedes the crisis.**

THE BIOIA SHIFT

BIOIA does not propose simply adding nature to the list of critical infrastructures.

It proposes **changing the point from which the list is constructed.**

Instead of beginning with what has already been institutionally classified, it begins with the material dependencies that make continuity possible.

This changes the sequence:

Territory + Experience + Reading → Orientation → Decision → Return → Continuity

Territory

Identifies where processes occur and what materially sustains them.

Experience

Provides situated signals, changes, memory, and knowledge that may not yet appear in formal indicators.

Reading

Relates data, patterns, dependencies, and connections without replacing territory or experience.

Orientation

Transforms that situated reading into direction:

What needs protection?

What needs restoration?

What should be prioritized?

Decision

Assigns resources, responsibilities, maintenance, and regulatory frameworks according to those dependencies.

Return

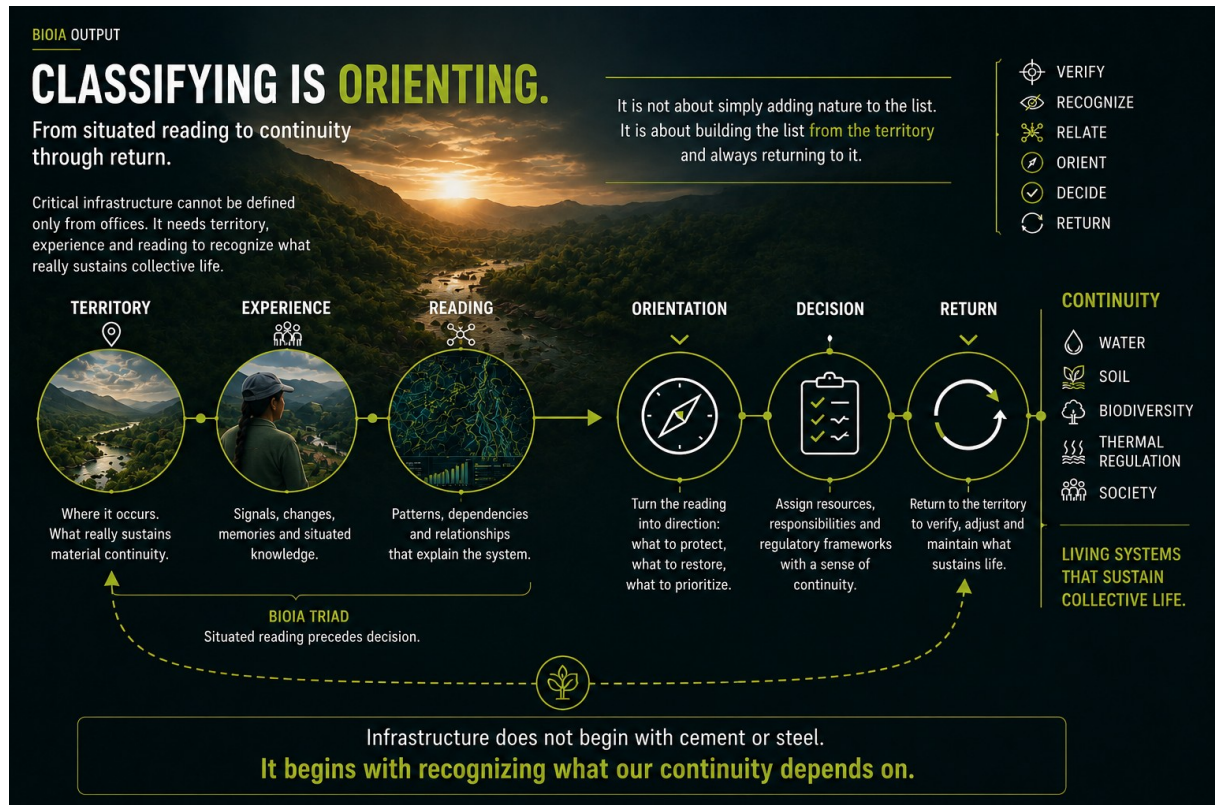
The decision returns to the territory to verify whether it actually protects, restores, or maintains what sustains continuity.

This closes the loop.

From repairing after collapse to maintaining before loss.

The shift may seem small, but it changes the entire architecture:

critical infrastructure is no longer defined only by what we have built, but also by what our continuity depends on.



Classifying is orienting. Critical infrastructure begins by recognizing, from the territory, the living systems on which collective continuity depends.

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Orientation precedes action.